CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Versatile and solution-oriented Senior Software Engineer with 9+ years of hands-on experience architecting and building scalable, service-oriented applications using Python, Django, Celery, and message-driven microservices. Proven expertise in system decomposition from monoliths, designing asynchronous backend architectures, and integrating robust observability and messaging frameworks including Kafka, RabbitMQ, and NATS. Adept at collaborating across multidisciplinary teams in agile settings to deliver high-performance backend services supporting business-critical workflows at scale.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python (AsyncIO, Django), Java (Spring Boot), JavaScript, TypeScript, Bash
- **Frameworks:** Django, Flask, FastAPI, Celery, Spring Boot
- **Architecture:** Microservices, SOA, Monolith Decomposition, RESTful APIs, Async Services
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, SQLite, MongoDB
- **Messaging & Streaming:** RabbitMQ, Kafka, NATS
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, AWS, GCP, Grafana, Prometheus
- **Tools:** Git, Jira, Grafana, New Relic, DataDog, Nginx, Elasticsearch
- **Testing:** PyTest, UnitTest, Postman, TDD
- **Methodologies:** Agile, Scrum, CI/CD, Code Review, Clean Code

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer
Sensidev
September 2021 – December 2024
Timişoara, Romania (Remote)

- Led decomposition of monolithic platform into distributed microservices using Python AsyncIO, enabling 40% faster deployment cycles and clearer service ownership boundaries.
- Developed high-availability REST APIs with Django and FastAPI, integrating message brokers like RabbitMQ and NATS to streamline asynchronous job processing.
- Designed scalable Celery task pipelines for background processing of high-volume event data, improving throughput by 55% while ensuring service resiliency.
- Integrated observability stack with Grafana and Prometheus to implement real-time monitoring, alerts, and distributed tracing for service health and performance.
- Collaborated with DevOps team to implement CI/CD pipelines on AWS with EKS and GitHub Actions, reducing manual deployment effort and risk of regressions.

- Introduced automated integration tests and contract testing across services to maintain system compatibility and mitigate breaking changes in a dynamic environment.
- Partnered with product and operations teams to refactor legacy logic, improving request handling performance by 65% and reducing error rates in customer-facing systems.
- Mentored 5+ junior engineers on best practices in async Python, service-oriented design, and performance optimization for distributed systems.

Software Engineer
Syscom Digital
October 2019 – August 2021
Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Developed and maintained Django-based applications with a strong focus on business-critical integrations involving external APIs and secure document processing.
- Migrated legacy synchronous services to async-enabled Python microservices, achieving up to 3x faster response times in high-load scenarios.
- Architected role-based access control and complex form processing using Django ORM, custom middleware, and PostgreSQL, ensuring compliance with enterprise policies.
- Wrote scalable Celery workers with retry logic and monitoring hooks, enhancing fault tolerance and visibility in the document automation workflows.
- Built Kafka-based ETL pipelines for ingesting and transforming marketing data, improving time-to-analysis and reducing data latency for BI dashboards.
- Participated in daily Scrum meetings, sprint planning, and backlog grooming sessions with product managers and QA engineers.
- Implemented unit and integration tests using PyTest and factory_boy, increasing test coverage from 40% to 85% and reducing production incidents.
- Contributed to the deployment automation process using Docker and Jenkins, standardizing builds and ensuring repeatable environment setups across dev/stage/prod.

Software Developer
Soft Build
June 2016 – July 2019
Timişoara, Romania (Remote)

- Delivered end-to-end backend solutions in Python and Java, focusing on modular architecture and reusable service components across multiple B2B platforms.
- Optimized legacy Django queries and implemented PostgreSQL indexes, leading to a 70% reduction in database response time for heavy analytics reports.
- Designed RESTful APIs and message-driven flows with RabbitMQ for internal tooling and third-party system integration, supporting real-time communication patterns.
- Contributed to containerizing and orchestrating the app ecosystem with Docker Compose and Kubernetes, simplifying onboarding and local development.
- Collaborated with frontend teams to design efficient API contracts and minimize response payloads, enhancing user experience and mobile performance.
- Built and maintained data caching layers using Redis to minimize redundant queries, cutting down response time significantly on high-traffic endpoints.
- Conducted peer reviews and knowledge-sharing sessions focused on secure coding and microservice interaction patterns.
- Enhanced deployment safety by integrating health checks and readiness probes in Kubernetes workloads, supporting rolling updates and zero-downtime releases.

Software Developer
Decima Digital
November 2015 – April 2016
Tallinn, Estonia

- Supported the transformation of a document-heavy legacy monolith into service-based modules using Django and PostgreSQL.
- Developed reusable Django apps with custom admin views for configuration-heavy internal tooling used by business teams.
- Participated in the setup of CI/CD workflows using GitLab CI and Docker, enabling quick deployment of changes to testing and staging environments.
- Integrated third-party authentication and document signing APIs, accelerating business onboarding processes for enterprise users.
- Wrote detailed documentation and onboarding guides to streamline new developer ramp-up and reduce knowledge silos.
- Performed system profiling and logging improvements using ELK stack to diagnose and fix memory leaks and API bottlenecks.
- Improved code quality and maintainability through refactoring, reducing duplication and enforcing consistency across backend modules.
- Built initial versions of automated testing suites for key flows using Selenium and PyTest for internal QA teams.

Software Developer Intern
Borna Technology
September 2014 – August 2015
Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Designed backend tools and admin interfaces in Django for managing digital assets and documents across multiple client portals.
- Assisted in building role-based access logic and validation flows with Django forms, sessions, and middleware, ensuring secure user interaction patterns.
- Wrote data migration scripts in Python for moving client records between database versions during version upgrades.
- Built asynchronous processing scripts using Celery for generating and distributing PDF reports and document summaries.
- Integrated REST APIs with frontend apps and supported QA in manual and automated testing phases for feature releases.
- Debugged and fixed performance issues in SQL queries and ORM operations to enhance user-facing page load times.
- Learned and applied Agile processes with Jira task tracking and sprint ceremonies to support collaborative feature delivery.
- Participated in internal code audits and team code reviews, fostering early exposure to quality engineering practices.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor’s Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Developer – Associate
- Kafka Streams & KSQL for Data Processing (Udemy)
- Django for Professionals (Advanced Track)
- Kubernetes for Developers – Production Grade Deployments
- Python AsyncIO Deep Dive (Real Python)

PROJECTS

- ✓ **Microservice Decomposition Platform:** Led transition from monolith to microservices with NATS and Kafka-based inter-service messaging on AWS EKS, reducing coupling and improving feature isolation.
- ✓ **Async Document Generation Engine:** Built a Celery + FastAPI-based backend for async PDF creation and delivery, reducing processing time by 60% and handling 1M+ documents monthly.
- ✓ **Distributed Alerting System:** Designed and deployed a Kubernetes-native monitoring system with Prometheus and Grafana to track and alert on application and queue-level metrics in real time.
- ✓ **Java-Python Hybrid Service Mesh:** Built an interop layer between Spring Boot and Python services using NATS and Protobuf, enabling seamless data exchange for audit and compliance tracking.
- ✓ **Scalable ETL Pipeline:** Engineered Kafka-based ingestion pipeline for processing millions of records daily, enriching and pushing into PostgreSQL + Elasticsearch stores with backpressure control.